



MicroConsole by year end

The TV version of cloud gaming site OnLive called MicroConsole will be available by year end

Graphics card test



ASUS EAH 5750

mark except for the underclocked Zotac 9800GT which inspite of being based on the G92 architecture, has only 112 stream processors (16 less than the standard count of 128). However, as will be seen in the graphs later, this does not affect the cards gaming performance which is at par with the Radeon HD 5670s.

The scaling prowess of *Crysis Warhead* comes through wonderfully in this category when compared with the previous categories. All the cards had a superb frame rate of above 70 fps for both the resolutions. We tried tweaking the settings from Low to Medium and still got over 30 fps for most of the cards.

Company of Heroes with its dynamic lighting still gave playable frame rates of over 50 fps at 1280x1024 and over 40 fps at 1680x1050. The NVIDIA GTS 250 proved better than the ATI cards for this game despite underclocked memory.

FarCry 2 gives the Asus EAH 5750 and PowerColor Radeon HD 5750 a slight edge over the GTS 250s.

Resident Evil 5 is another game that results in a close fight between Asus 5750, Zotac GTS 250, PowerColor 5750 and Big GTS 250 with frame rates crossing 70 fps (1680x1050) and touching 90 fps (1280x1024). The HD 5670s and Zotac

9800GT also give very decent playable frame rates of 50 fps (1680x1050).

Heaven v2.0 also gave impressive scores crossing the 930 mark and 37 fps for cards like Asus 5750, Zotac GTS 250, Big GeForce GTS 250 and PowerColor 5750. Biostar GTS250 gave no score in this benchmark surprisingly as the benchmark crashed each time we ran it.

On the whole this was one category where the performances were wonderful and very close at the same time. The only major drop in frame rates was apparent among the HD 5670s and Zotac 9800GT which is understandable as the stream processors, texture processing units and raster operator units are comparatively lower to HD 5750s and GTS 250s respectively. But as standalone graphic cards, each of them gave playable rates at both the benchmarked settings and resolutions.

Another interesting finding from the scores was the identical performance of Zotac GTS 250 and Big GeForce GTS 250, despite a 512 MB VRAM on the former. It just reiterates the fact that more isn't necessarily better, as in the entry level cards, one will not tend to play beyond 1920x1080. Even at that resolution the difference between the two cards is so miniscule that it does not affect the gaming performance. Also the Zotac GTS 250 is Rs. 300 cheaper and comes with a game bundled in. The only reason to go for a 1 GB card in this case is future proofing for more VRAM hungry games.

Finally when it came to deciding the winner, it was a very close call. PowerColor Radeon HD 5750 was awarded the Best Performer, while the Best Buy went to Asus EAH 5750. Although we felt that Sapphire HD 5670 was a tad overpriced at Rs. 7400 considering its configurations are similar to

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